



HNDIT4242-Computer Services Management



Week 06

Customer Liaison (Help Desk & Service Desk)



Lesson Objectives

- Understand the **role of IT support teams** and differentiate between a **Help Desk** and a **Service Desk**.
- Explain how **fault logging and problem management** are handled in IT service management.
- Learn **incident management frameworks** such as **ITIL (Information Technology Infrastructure Library)**.
- Understand **customer account management** in IT services, including **security measures** and **customer relationship management (CRM) systems**.
- Identify **key ITSM (IT Service Management) tools** used for customer support.



1. Help Desk vs. Service Desk

1.1 Definition and Importance

- Both Help Desks and Service Desks are crucial in IT support, but they serve different purposes.

Feature	Help Desk	Service Desk
Purpose	Handles technical issues (e.g., password resets, network issues).	Manages service requests (e.g., software installation, user onboarding).
Focus	Reactive – Solves issues as they occur.	Proactive – Aims to improve overall IT service management.
Scope	Limited to technical support .	Covers IT service management (ITSM) as a whole.
Users	Employees and end-users.	IT teams, business stakeholders, and customers.
Examples	Basic IT support, troubleshooting, hardware issues.	IT service requests, access management, system updates.



1.2 Examples of IT Help Desk and Service Desk Tools

- **Jira Service Management** – Tracks issues, automates workflows.
- **ServiceNow** – Manages IT service requests, incidents, and change management.
- **Zendesk** – Helps businesses provide customer support.
- **Freshdesk** – A cloud-based customer support platform.



1.3 Role of IT Support Teams in an Organization

- Provides **technical support** to employees and customers.
- Ensures **minimal downtime** for IT services.
- Improves **user experience** by resolving issues efficiently.



2. Fault Logging and Problem Management

2.1 Fault Logging Process in IT Service Management

- Fault logging helps organizations **track, analyze, and resolve IT issues** systematically.
- **Steps in Fault Logging:**
 - **Issue Identification** – Detect an issue (e.g., server crash).
 - **Ticket Creation** – Log the issue in an ITSM tool.
 - **Issue Classification** – Categorize the fault (e.g., hardware/software issue).
 - **Assign to Support Team** – Assign to the right department (e.g., network team, software team).
 - **Resolution and Closure** – Fix the issue and document the solution.
- **Example Fault Logging in ServiceNow:**
 - User submits a **service request** → The system assigns it a **ticket number** → IT team investigates and resolves it.



2.2 Problem-Solving Frameworks in ITSM

Organizations use structured frameworks to manage IT issues efficiently.

1. ITIL (Information Technology Infrastructure Library):

- **Incident Management** – Resolves **immediate** issues.
- **Problem Management** – Identifies **root causes** and prevents future issues.
- **Change Management** – Ensures smooth **system upgrades**.

2. Root Cause Analysis (RCA):

- Identifies the **underlying cause** of IT problems.
- Uses techniques like **5 Whys Analysis** and **Fishbone Diagrams**.



3. Customer Account Management in IT Services

3.1 Role of Customer Account Management

- Customer account management involves:
 - **Handling user access requests.**
 - **Providing support for user accounts** (e.g., password resets, access revocation).
 - **Ensuring security** through identity and access management.



3.2 IT Systems for Managing Customer Relationships

Organizations use **Customer Relationship Management (CRM) systems** to manage user interactions.

Popular CRM Tools:

- **Salesforce** – Automates sales and customer service.
- **HubSpot** – Helps track customer interactions.
- **Zoho CRM** – Provides customer support and data analysis.



3.3 Security in Customer Account Management

Managing IT accounts requires strict security measures:

- **Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA):** Requires extra verification steps beyond passwords.
- **Role-Based Access Control (RBAC):** Assigns permissions based on job roles.
- **Data Encryption:** Protects sensitive customer information.



Summary

- **Help Desk and Service Desk** serve different but complementary roles in IT support.
- **Fault logging** ensures IT issues are **tracked and resolved efficiently**.
- **Problem management frameworks (ITIL, RCA)** help prevent recurring IT issues.
- **Customer account management** ensures **secure and efficient** handling of user data.
- **CRM systems** improve **customer service and support operations**.



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